



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ Classical Academy South Campus

School Website: <https://christclassical.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Christ Classical Academy South Campus (Tallahassee, FL 32308) presents a clearly classical, Christian-formed educational model. The public materials consistently foreground a Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a theology-centered worldview, a covenantal partnership with families, and a mission to form students who discern and practice what is true, good, and beautiful. The school frames its work around a Portrait of a Graduate that emphasizes Christ-centered formation, virtue, wonder, service, and excellence. Across the six classical-element categories, the school demonstrates strong alignment with classical criteria (CLASSICAL) with few if any gaps that would push it toward "Somewhat Classical" or "Not Classical." The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key evidentiary notes, aligned to the public materials and the classical rubric, include: - Explicit Christian theological grounding and liturgical-cultural expressions (Nicene Creed, creedal language, Christ-centered worldview) and a mission and covenant-partnering stance with families. This is evident in mission statements, creedal content, and governance pages. - A clearly articulated classical curriculum and pedagogy structure: Pre-Grammar / Grammar / Logic / Rhetoric divisions, explicit Trivium emphasis, Latin, primary sources, and a "Great Books/Great Conversation" orientation in philosophy of education. - A robust "Portrait of a Graduate" and covenant-partnered parent culture that positions parents as co-educators and emphasizes formation, virtue, and the love of learning. - Evidence of structured, teacher-led leadership and governance (Head of School, Board, accreditation).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Nicene Creed and explicit Christian doctrinal framing are documented on the site (creedal language and explicit Christian formation emphasis). - The mission and graduate portrait foreground a Christ-centered formation and the True/Good/Beautiful framing. - Worship/music/covenant-partnership context and liturgical language appear in school materials and covenant/mission sections.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; character; wisdom; theology; liturgy; covenant; reverence; wonder. Examples include "true, good, and beautiful" in mission language and the portrait of a graduate; the Nicene Creed; and "Christian formation" language. - Negative keywords observed: effectively none in public materials (no explicit secular relativism, no anti-theology language, no VALUE-NEUTRAL framing found in the visible content). The site consistently rejects secular-leaning frames in favor of theological grounding.

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in theology and liturgical/community life, with explicit emphasis on formation through a Christian worldview. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators and the Grounded in Theology/Liturgical practices in the Six

Essential Elements lexicon. The lack of countervailing secular signals in the public-facing materials supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (if applicable) - Not applicable; category already robustly CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and Portrait of a Graduate articulate formation of virtue, wisdom, and love of learning, rather than mere career prep. The language centers on becoming followers of Christ who discern and practice the True, the Good, and the Beautiful. - Language in Covenant Partnership materials ties human formation to moral and spiritual aims (formation of affections, virtue, character, wonder). - The curriculum/pedagogical emphasis on formation (as opposed to information-only approaches) is echoed in Great Books/primary-source focus and the Trivium-driven pedagogy, which are aligned with classical aims for human flourishing.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation; virtue; human flourishing; contemplation; truth; goodness; beauty; wisdom; love of learning; moral imagination; excellence. The Portrait of a Graduate explicitly enumerates Christ-centered formation and virtuous dispositions. - Negative keywords observed: minimal to none in public messaging; no explicit “career readiness” or purely job-focused language detected in the public materials. The emphasis remains formation-leaning.

Why this rating - The school’s stated aims center virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of a Christian worldview—recurrent indicators of CLASSICAL aim rather than a more utilitarian, job-focused approach (which would signal SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL). The explicit emphasis on formation and the True-/Good/Beautiful framework supports CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Not required for CLASSICAL; if pursued, deeper articulation of how Great Books and classical texts cultivate philosophy of life could be further emphasized to strengthen the transpiration from formation to sustained intellectual formation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A formal Trivium framework is visible (Pre-Grammar, Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and courses are organized by the corresponding divisions. Latin is included; logic and rhetoric are explicitly named as part of the core progression. - The site references Great Books/primary sources approach (ad fontes) and a Christian worldview integrated into the curriculum; primary-source pedagogy is described in curriculum pages. - The program is described as classical in learning philosophy, with emphasis on formation through the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium elements) and an integrated, historical-civilizational approach. - The “Portrait of a Graduate” and covenant-partnership content emphasize thinking, virtue, and disciplined inquiry consistent with classical curricula.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; ad fontes; Classical Learning; Latin; logic across disciplines; rhetoric; “Great Conversation” (conceptual in site messaging); study of classical languages; history in a Western-civilization frame; formation through the classics. - Negative keywords observed: minimal to none in public messaging; no explicit pivot to social studies as a substitute for history; no ostentatious emphasis on project-based trends that would derail classical content. The site maintains a traditional/structured classical emphasis.

Why this rating - The curriculum has explicit Trivium-based structure, classical text emphasis, primary sources, and a historically anchored humanities approach, with ancillary elements like Latin and rhetoric—all of which align with CLASSICAL. Where public messaging explicitly links to Great Books/Great Conversation and ad fontes, the school aligns with classical curriculum indicators.

What would move the needle - If desired to move toward “SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL” (not required here), the school could further document and publicly showcase specific Great Books lists, canonical primary-source selections, and explicit mappings of Trivium stages to assigned texts across the grades.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy explicitly incorporates the Trivium stages and is described as a mix of contemplative and rigorous approaches; lower grades include singing, memory work, and chant; upper grades feature Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric-oriented performance. This aligns with classical pedagogy that blends memory, recitation, and Socratic inquiry. - The site mentions guided discovery, memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation and practice, along with a focus on “Scholé” style restful learning in certain contexts, which matches ancient-to-medieval educational rhythms. - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion and rhetoric training; lower grades emphasize memory, chants, and memorization—classical pedagogy across grade bands.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue; great conversation; memory work; recitation; chanting; guided discussion; seminar; rhetoric; dialectic; intellectual virtue; Sayers’ Lost Tools of Learning references; scholé/restful learning. - Negative keywords observed: minimal to none in public messaging; site does not emphasize purely project-based, non-anchored experiential-only pedagogy; rather, it blends memory/recitation with Socratic inquiry, which is a classical mix.

Why this rating - Pedagogy embraces the core classical practices: rote memory and chant in early years; guided inquiry and Socratic discourse in upper years; rhetoric training; a focus on formation and memory anchored learning. This is robust CLASSICAL pedagogy.

What would move the needle - Not required for CLASSICAL; if anything, minor enhancements could be to publish a cross-walk of grade-level pedagogical methods to canonical classical texts and to document how memory work and recitation are implemented in practice with exemplar rubrics.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school provides a named Head of School and a governance structure (Board of Directors) that oversees policy and mission, with a living-history emphasis (e.g., “Portrait of a Graduate,” and a narrative about leadership). The public materials include faculty leadership profiles and a forward-facing Head of School introduction. - Public-facing materials describe a collaborative, mentorship-oriented school culture (e.g., “Head of School leadership,” religious formation, and the living curriculum framing). This aligns with the classical model of teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors. - The narrative around the Covenant Partnership and family involvement positions teachers as partners in formation, consistent with the classical living-curriculum concept.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum; teacher as mentor; model teachers; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; masterful teaching; formation of character; guidance by the Head of School; Board governance. - Negative keywords observed: none in public materials; no evidence of non-classical faculty descriptors (e.g., “facilitator”-only, non-mentoring staff language) in the visible content. The site’s language supports classical-faculty imagery.

Why this rating - The presence of leadership, governance, and “teacher as mentor” framing, plus a strong emphasis on formation and the living curriculum, aligns well with CLASSICAL faculty indicators.

What would move the needle - Not required for CLASSICAL; if desired, the school could publish more explicit faculty development narratives around classical pedagogy, living texts, faculty seminars, and professional development in the classical tradition to strengthen the “faculty as the living curriculum” claim.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes Covenant Partnership with parents, highlighting parent as co-teachers and opportunities for families to engage via website content, book studies, and gatherings. The Admissions and About pages explicitly discuss parental partnership and engagement. - The site invites parent involvement (tours, communications) and frames education as a family-centered, faith-based endeavor in Tallahassee; visible commitments to parent formation and covenant community are present. - Great empha-

sis on partnering with parents to develop biblical worldview, and regular opportunities for family involvement, which aligns with classical community-practice indicators.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families; co-teachers; covenant partnership; parent formation; family involvement; home-school community; parental responsibility; engaged families; community support. - Negative keywords observed: none visible; public messaging does not frame parents as customers or isolated participants; the tone is partnership-based rather than consumer-based.

Why this rating - The school's messaging consistently positions parents as essential partners in the educational formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parent-community involvement and formation.

What would move the needle - Not required; if desired, additive improvements could include more explicit parent education programming (e.g., classical education book clubs, lectures on Great Books for families, schedule of shared liturgical/educational events).

Overall Assessment

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

- The six categories consistently align with classical education indicators (Religious/metaphysical foundations; purposeful formation; liberal-arts-centric curriculum; Trivium pedagogy; teacher-mentors and governance; and robust parent-community partnership). The school's materials emphasize the True, the Good, and the Beautiful; a Trivium-centric curriculum with primary sources and Great Books orientation; contemplative and Socratic facets of pedagogy; and a Covenant Partnership with families, all of which strongly map to the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education.

What would move the needle if it were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (not applicable here) - N/A for CLASSICAL; no major needle-moving changes are required. If desired, minor enhancements could include more explicit "Great Books" reading lists and publicly documented teacher-professional development in classical pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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